

Power Move 9: Culture as the Operating System



Let's Connect Some Dots

This worksheet is not a recap of the chapter. It is the conversion. Turn culture from a vibe into mechanisms: standards, scorecards, training, and enforcement.

THE PROMISE YOU ARE PROTECTING

Write the promise the market is buying. If the promise is fuzzy, culture will be fuzzy.

Brand promise (one sentence):

What the customer must consistently feel (3 words):

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

YOUR TOP 5 ENFORCED STANDARDS

Write five enforceable standards. Write them as rules. No values-on-a-wall language.

Standards (write 5):

- 1.
- 2.

3.

4.

5.

Definitions (use once):

Meets standard = what is observable when the standard is being kept.

Misses standard = what is observable when the standard is being broken.

Meets standard (observable):

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Misses standard (observable):

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

PREFERENCES VS STANDARDS (KILL MICROMANAGEMENT)

Write three preferences you will stop enforcing. Then write the real standard (the outcome you actually care about).

Preferences to stop enforcing (write 3):

1.
2.
3.

Actual standards (the outcome that matters) (write 3):

1.
2.
3.

THE CULTURE SCORECARD (5 CATEGORIES)

Pick five categories that protect the promise. If a category cannot be observed, it cannot be enforced.

Write each category like this:

Category name = what gets scored.

Definition = what “good” means here.

Observable behaviors = what a leader can see in work, communication, and follow-through.

Examples (swap into your brand language):

- *Ownership: flags problems early, proposes solutions, closes loops.*
- *Clarity: writes clean handoffs, asks precise questions, documents decisions.*
- *Follow-through: hits deadlines, confirms next steps, does not ghost.*
- *Boundary enforcement: protects scope, uses the script, does not cave under pressure.*
- *Craft: low error rate, minimal revision loops, ships clean.*

Category 1 name:

Definition (one sentence):

Observable behaviors (3):

1.

2.

3.

Category 2 name:

Definition (one sentence):

Observable behaviors (3):

1.

2.

3.

Definition (one sentence):

Observable behaviors (3):

1.

2.

3.

Category 4 name:

Definition (one sentence):

Observable behaviors (3):

1.

2.

3.

Category 5 name:

Definition (one sentence):

Observable behaviors (3):

1.

2.

3.

Scale (choose one):

1-3 (misses / meets / raises)

1-5 (only if you will actually use it)

Chosen scale:

INSTALL IT STARTING WITH THREE INTERNAL TOUCHPOINTS

Culture does not hold without repetition. Pick three internal touchpoints you will run. These are recurring moments where standards get trained, inspected, and reinforced.

TOUCHPOINT 1: ONBOARDING

When it happens:

What gets taught/installed:

What gets observed:

TOUCHPOINT 2: INSPECTION

When it happens:

What gets reviewed:

What gets corrected:

TOUCHPOINT 3: REINFORCEMENT

When it happens:

What gets recognized:

What gets repeated:

WHO THRIVES HERE

This is a lite version of your ICA work applied to your team. It is not a job description. It is a portrait of the kind of person who naturally aligns with your culture and mission. Available talent may influence how closely a new hire hits these marks. You still want to recognize a good fit when you see it. This exercise helps you do that.

POSTURE & VALUES

What internal posture do people need to have to thrive here? (e.g., ownership mindset, curiosity, stewardship, willingness to learn, respect for standards)

HOW THEY SHOW UP

What behaviors do you see in people who fit? (e.g., they ask clarifying questions before starting, they document their work, they flag problems early, they respect the mission over convenience)

WHAT THEY CARE ABOUT

What matters to them? (e.g., impact, growth, clarity, being part of something bigger)

doing work that aligns with their values)

RED FLAGS: WHO DOESN'T FIT

What postures or behaviors signal misalignment? (e.g., they argue with the foundation before understanding it, they prioritize their way over the brand's way, they see the role as transactional, they resist feedback)

GREEN FLAGS: WHO DOES FIT

What postures or behaviors signal alignment? (e.g., they ask about the mission first, they want to understand before executing, they take pride in the details, they see themselves as part of building something).